

RETURNING CLIENT WORKSHEET



Purpose: Build systems that make returning to coaching feel natural, professional, and easy—so former clients re-engage without pressure or persuasion.

Level Setting: Creating a returning client pipeline begins before they end their initial coaching experience. Most clients do not leave because coaching failed. They leave because:

- Life circumstances changed
- A short-term goal was achieved
- There was no clear “next phase”

If a client exits without intention, clarity, or context, re-engagement becomes harder and more awkward later. This means that creating a returning client pipeline begins with how you offboard them. Your goal is to ensure every client exits feeling:

- Supported, not dropped
- Successful, not finished
- Clear that returning is normal and expected

Below are steps you can take to build a robust pipeline for returning clients.

Step 1: Make Sure Clients Exit with Intention

When offboarding a client, ensure that the process is as thorough and intentional as the onboarding process. Use the following offboarding checklist to ensure your clients leave with intentionality, clarity, and a roadmap to return.

- ☐ Every client exit has a documented reason
- ☐ The exit is framed as a transition or pause, not an ending
- ☐ Clients are told when returning might make sense
- ☐ Clients are told how returning would work
- ☐ The relationship is left open and positive

Ensure that each client who offboards knows exactly what it would look like to return as a client in 6 months, 12 months, or many years from now.



Step 2: Customize Reachout for Re-Engagement

It can be easy to fall into the trap of lazy marketing and rely on simple email or text automations to reach out to clients. Remember that each client left for a specific reason, make sure your re-engagement efforts are specific to their reasons. For each client, make sure to note the following and create segments for each in your CRM software.

Reason for exit: _____

Last major win or challenge: _____

Likely current barrier: _____

Step 3: Initiate Re-Engagement Outreach

The goal of this phase is to rekindle the relationship, not to immediately sell your former clients. This outreach can be conversation openers, questions, “thinking of you” articles, or other value adds for former clients. Use the following list to review as you prepare to initiate re-engagement outreach. Outreach is personal and specific

- References prior work or shared context
- Uses curiosity, not urgency
- Does NOT lead with an offer or discount

Think of this phase as a warm up. The goal is not to immediately sell your former clients but rather to re-initiate dialogue and rekindle the relationship.

Step 4: Reframe

As you begin to open up conversations with former clients, you may encounter initial resistance. This is where your conversations can pivot and help clients reframe their thought process from “starting over” to “the next phase”. These conversations are not meant for clients to think about “going back” but thinking about “what is next”. Use the following list to help ensure your communications are steering the conversation in the right direction.

- Coaching is framed in phases, not forever
- Returning is positioned as continuation, not reset
- Language includes: phase, evolution, refinement, next step
- Current life context is acknowledged



Step 5: Lower the Friction to Return

Make it as simple and frictionless as possible for clients to return. They already went through the initial coaching process so you can accelerate their onboarding. Make this process easier and faster than it is for new clients. Use the following best practices for adjusting your business systems to specifically handle returning clients

- ➔ No full re-onboarding unless necessary
- ➔ Short recommitment option (30–60 days)
- ➔ Clear expectation reset (not total reset)
- ➔ Simple scheduling and restart process

Final Systems Action Plan

Instructions: Review your results from above and write down the top 3 gaps in your re-engagement strategy you identified from the worksheet and then create a plan to create or improve one system this quarter.

Top Re-Engagement Gaps

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

One System to Implement This Quarter

Notes

